WEEKLY JOURNAL DIGEST

Weekly journal digest for 2026-10-05 to 2026-10-10

Curated articles in political communication and computational social science.

SPECIAL ISSUE UPDATES

Calls checked: 2026-10-10.

Manual calls omitted pending renewed official-page verification: Public Relations Review.

Special Issue: New Directions in Influencer Research
Journal of Advertising Research | Deadline within 14 days | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-10-12
Official call / submission details

Special Issue: Older Adult Communication Across Contexts
Communication Quarterly | Deadline within 14 days | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-10-15
Official call / submission details

Thematic Issue: Reconceptualizing Deliberative Democracy and Journalism in AI-Mediated Public Spheres
Media and Communication | Deadline within 14 days | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-10-15
Official call / submission details

Thematic Issue: Social Media Journalism as a One-Way Street?
Media and Communication | Deadline within 14 days | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-10-15
Official call / submission details

Special Collection: Divisive politics, polarisation and democratic decline
Humanities & Social Sciences Communications | Newly found | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-12-11
Official call / submission details

Special Issue: Advancing Research in Immunization Services: Communication Strategies, Innovation, and Equity for Vaccine Confidence and Uptake
Journal of Health Communication | Newly found | call for papers
Deadline: 2026-12-22
Official call / submission details

Special Issue: Relational Perspectives in Journalism (Studies)
Journalism Studies | Updated | call for papers
Deadline: 2027-02-01
Official call / submission details

Special Collection: Health Communications and Public Engagement
npj Digital Public Health | Newly found | call for papers
Deadline: 2027-02-14
Official call / submission details

Thematic Issue: Democracy-Sensitive Journalism: Rethinking Journalistic Responsibilities in Times of Democratic Backsliding
Media and Communication | Newly found | call for papers
Deadline: 2027-06-15
Official call / submission details

SUMMARY

This week, COMAP Journal Bot follows the politics of feeds, memories, and institutional judgment. A TikTok audit tracks the partisan imbalance encountered by new nonpartisan users before German elections; school-history research shows how national narratives shape present-day foreign-policy attitudes; and new work on crime, climate justice, clientelism, and collective action examines when institutions mobilize, exclude, or redirect public participation.

The computational reading is unusually cohesive. Networked LLM agents develop polarized political opinions, AI-mediated apologies and gratitude alter judgments of sincerity, personalized algorithms enter vaccination risk communication, and an audit of autonomous AI scientists exposes research flaws that final manuscripts can conceal. Complementary studies sharpen behavioral-model validation, signed-network analysis, prison-visitation policy, newsroom AI evaluation, environmental governance, and urban heat inequality.

You may have received two September 7 emails because the first was sent before that collection window closed; the second completed the same edition. Saturday delivery now aligns collection and sending, so each future email represents a distinct Monday-Saturday edition.

HIGHLIGHTS

Does the TikTok Feed Lean Right? Exposure to Political Content Among Non-Partisan Users in Germany

POLITICAL COMMUNICATION · 2026-10-05

Why it matters · Audits what brand-new, nonpartisan TikTok accounts encounter before German elections and finds that unsolicited political exposure disproportionately features and supports the far-right AfD.

Open article →

Algorithm-assisted personalized risk communication to encourage flu vaccination in the USA: three randomized field trials

NATURE HUMAN BEHAVIOUR · 2026-10-05

Why it matters · Places algorithm-assisted personalization directly inside vaccination risk communication across three randomized field trials, linking AI-mediated messaging to consequential health behavior.

Open article →

Emergence of polarization in networks of large language model agents

NATURE COMMUNICATIONS · 2026-10-08

Why it matters · Simulates thousands of networked LLM agents across several model families to study how homophily, confirmation bias, and interaction structure can produce political polarization.

Open article →

The sequential replicant effect in interpersonal sincerity: evidence from AI-mediated apology and gratitude

JOURNAL OF COMPUTER-MEDIATED COMMUNICATION · 2026-10-08

Why it matters · Uses two preregistered studies of AI-mediated apologies and gratitude to show how disclosed AI involvement changes perceived sincerity and later relational judgments.

Open article →

Teaching the past, informing the present? School history education and attitudes toward foreign countries

AMERICAN JOURNAL OF POLITICAL SCIENCE · 2026-10-08

Why it matters · Connects classroom history narratives to contemporary foreign-policy attitudes using evidence from 34 classrooms in Seoul, clarifying how institutionalized memory shapes cooperation and conflict.

Open article →

Crime and Participation

AMERICAN POLITICAL SCIENCE REVIEW · 2026-10-06

Why it matters · Combines a preregistered urban survey with five election-study waves to distinguish how victimization, local crime, and perceived safety affect turnout and nonelectoral participation.

Open article →

Costly missed connections: Visitation and misconduct in California prisons

SCIENCE ADVANCES · 2026-10-09

Why it matters · Uses gasoline-price shocks, smartphone mobility traces, and administrative records to estimate how prison visitation affects misconduct and institutional safety.

Open article →

The more you automate, the less you see: Hidden pitfalls of autonomous AI scientists

PROCEEDINGS OF THE NATIONAL ACADEMY OF SCIENCES · 2026-10-05

Why it matters · Audits open-source autonomous AI scientist systems and shows why benchmark choice, leakage, metric misuse, and post hoc selection require workflow-level rather than manuscript-only review.

Open article →

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- Science Advances

Previous Week Catch-Up

- Science Advances

COLLECTION SNAPSHOT

TOTAL COLLECTED CANDIDATES	NEW THIS WEEK CANDIDATES	PREVIOUS WEEK CATCH-UP CANDIDATES
317	174	142
LATE ADDITIONS CANDIDATES		
1		

Curated digest below: 17 new, 1 catch-up, 0 late additions

The full collected set above passed automatic source filters and precedes manual relevance review; the curated digest applies the stricter COMAP threshold.

All 17 article sources completed for the 2026-09-13 through 2026-10-10 collection window, with no source failures or recorded optional-enrichment errors.

October 3 selections are not repeated. The catch-up paper was newly indexed after that edition.

FULL CURATED DIGEST

New This Week

American Journal of Political Science

Teaching the past, informing the present? School history education and attitudes toward foreign countries

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1111/AJPS.70082

Soyoung Lee; Jeongmin Park

Assistant Professor, Department of Political Science Yale University New Haven Connecticut USA; Postdoctoral Prize Fellow, Department of Politics Oxford University Nuffield College Oxford UK

Abstract. Abstract How does school history education emphasizing past grievances with other countries impact attitudes toward conflict and cooperation with the countries today? We examine this question using original data from 34 classrooms across 17 high schools in Seoul, South Korea. We first test whether exposure to antiJapanese content in school history education negatively impacts students' attitudes toward cooperation with Japan. We then compare how the attitudes of students educated with a more proUS textbook differ from those using a more antiUS one. We find that school history education influenced what historical events students believed as "facts" and their evaluation of historical events. However, the effect on students' historical memories did not by itself automatically translate into corresponding attitudes toward presentday Japan or the United States. Our findings offer various implications for studies on international rivalries and historical memories, as well as for debates on the political effects of school education.

Read article →

American Political Science Review

The Idea of a Counter-Structure: Rethinking Collective Action against Climate Injustice

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1017/S0003055426101920

JONATHAN MASIN-PETERS

Harvard University

Abstract. This article argues that addressing the structural injustices of climate change requires rethinking collective action. Disruptive and prefigurative politics are often treated as separate collective action repertoires, but I argue that a just energy transition requires that they work in tandem. To capture this interaction, I propose the idea of "counter-structural" collective action, in which disruptive protest creates windows of opportunity that prefigurative alternatives can then fill. Through analysis of two UK climate movements, Transition Towns (TTs) and Camps for Climate Action (CCA), I show how activists reconfigure structural elements to build new, carbon-free social and political forms. The theory of counter-structural action provides a framework for assessing the empirical cases. The cases, in turn, illustrate a broader conception of collective action that better reflects the social theory grounding structural injustice. Together, the theory and cases support the dual aims of climate justice: challenging fossil-fuel path dependence and advancing egalitarianism.

Read article →

When Can Clientelism Serve Democratic Ends? A Democratic Theory of Distributive Politics

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1017/S0003055426101816

SAMUEL ELY BAGG; UDIT BHATIA

King's College London; University of South Carolina

Abstract. This article employs normative democratic theory to examine a counterintuitive suggestion raised repeatedly by empirical scholars of clientelism: namely, that practices of particularistic exchange might sometimes serve democratic ends. Certainly, most particularistic practices are widely agreed to undermine democracy, on both intrinsic and instrumental grounds. Yet some observers resist blanket condemnation-and in particular, many highlight the redeeming democratic virtues of certain practices that seem to facilitate collective organization among disempowered groups. Drawing on "realist" approaches to democratic theory, we vindicate this basic insight while clarifying its scope conditions. Countervailing power is a crucial democratic priority, and programmatic methods of promoting it sometimes face serious obstacles: as when clientelist practices are deeply entrenched, or incumbents capture the tools of programmatic competition. Under such conditions, we conclude, democracy-seeking leaders may justifiably employ particularistic practices to promote countervailing power-but only if they respect five constraints tethering them strictly to that goal.

Read article →

Crime and Participation

2026-10-06 · DOI 10.1017/S0003055426102007

DAVID DOHERTY; G. AGUSTIN MARKARIAN; MENA WHALEN; DANA GARBARSKI

Loyola University Chicago

Abstract. Does exposure to crime mobilize or demobilize political participation? We report findings from a preregistered design, leveraging data from an original survey of 21 major U.S. cities and five waves of the Cooperative Election Study. We assess the relationships between direct victimization, local (ZCTA-level) crime rates, and perceived neighborhood safety and two outcomes: turnout (including validated turnout) and non-electoral participation. We find that direct victimization is significantly associated with more non-electoral engagement but lower turnout. The negative estimated effects of victimization on turnout exceed the magnitude of positive effects associated with common get-out-the-vote efforts. We find only limited evidence that crime rates are associated with participation. Perceived neighborhood safety is associated with higher rates of non-electoral, but not electoral, participation. Our findings offer new, comprehensive evidence on the relationship between crime exposure and political participation and illustrate the importance of distinguishing between types of exposure and forms of participation.

Read article →

Journal of Computer-Mediated Communication

The sequential replicant effect in interpersonal sincerity: evidence from AI-mediated apology and gratitude

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1093/JCMC/ZMAG024

Bolin Cao; Zhenming Li

Cardiff Business School, Cardiff University , Cardiff, Wales,; School of Media and Communication, Shenzhen University , Shenzhen, Guangdong,

Abstract. Abstract Sincerity, a core interpersonal value that mobilizes emotional resources, faces distinct challenges in AI-mediated interpersonal contexts. Extending the Replicant Effect from informational trust to interpersonal sincerity, this study examines how AIMC awareness and AI involvement cues shape sincerity judgments and subsequent relational responses. Drawing on two pre-registered, two-round studies in apology (N = 546) and gratitude (N = 561) scenarios, we found that AI involvement cues reliably reduced perceived sincerity. Primed AIMC awareness showed a more sequential influence on later no-cue evaluations through AIMC suspicion. High-ambiguity AI cues produced sequential effects only in the gratitude context. These findings suggest that hybrid human-AI authorship may reshape how interpersonal sincerity is inferred and validated, while also showing that the effects of AI cues and AIMC awareness depend on cue clarity and relational context.

Read article →

Nature Communications

Distinguishing learning asymmetry from perseveration in behavioral models

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1038/S41467-026-78198-1

Juan Vidal-Perez; Raymond J. Dolan; Rani Moran

Abstract. Abstract A central challenge in cognitive science is to distinguish between multiple processes that can result in similar behaviors. In reinforcement learning, one prominent example concerns two potential drivers of choice repetition: a learning asymmetry, in which agents learn differently from outcomes depending on their valence and/or whether they confirm choice, and choice perseveration, an outcome-independent tendency to repeat past choices. Evidence for asymmetric learning has typically relied on computational models that control for perseveration, or specific behavioral markers. Here, we show both these approaches have critical flaws and can spuriously detect learning asymmetries even in perseverative, symmetric-learning agents. To address this, we introduce a statistical test that distinguishes genuine learning asymmetries from spurious effects. Applying this test to a large dataset spanning ten published experiments across four studies, we find that some previously reported confirmation biases are fragile, albeit others remain robust even at an across-study level. Finally, we propose a task design that can yield a more valid qualitative signature of confirmation bias. Our approach provides a reliable framework for disentangling processes underlying choice repetition, while providing tools for the wider research community that can minimize potential spurious effects arising from process mimicry and biased parameter estimation.

Read article →

Emergence of polarization in networks of large language model agents

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1038/S41467-026-78228-Y

Jinghua Piao; Zhihong Lu; Chen Gao; Fengli Xu; Qinghua Hu; Fernando P. Santos; Yong Li; James Evans

Abstract. Abstract Rapid advances in large language models (LLMs) have empowered autonomous agents to generate social networks, communicate, and form shared and diverging opinions on political issues. However, our understanding of their collective behaviours and underlying mechanisms remains incomplete. In this paper, we simulate networked systems involving thousands of LLM agents across different backbone models (GPT-3.5, GPT-4o, ChatGLM, Llama-3, and DeepSeek-V3), in which agents interact through LLM-guided conversations and update their opinions over time, resulting in the emergence of opinion polarization. We discover that these agents spontaneously develop their own social network with properties characteristic of human social networks, such as homophilic clustering. The collective opinions of these LLM agents evolve in ways that exhibit behavioural patterns consistent with social phenomena and mechanisms widely discussed in empirical studies of human behaviour and opinion-dynamics models. This consistency suggests that LLM agents can serve as a valuable synthetic testbed for exploring hypothetical intervention strategies in networked LLM-agent systems. Using this testbed, we further examine the effects of a range of network- and individual-level interventions, such as promoting more diverse interactions and reducing confirmation bias. Overall, this work not only sheds light on subtle opinion dynamics and collective behaviour of LLM agents from a network perspective, but also demonstrates their potential for testing hypotheses about opinion dynamics and intervention strategies.

Read article →

The limits of Antarctic conservation governance

2026-10-06 · DOI 10.1038/S41467-026-77606-W

Zachary T. Carter; Larissa Lubiana Botelho; Steven L. Chown; Parsa Yaryab; Nadiah P. Kristensen; Kerrie A. Wilson; Daniela Liggett; Michael Bode

Abstract. Abstract The Antarctic region exerts a profound influence on the Earth system, making its conservation fundamental to sustaining planetary health and human wellbeing. The Antarctic Treaty System (ATS) holds near-exclusive authority for environmental protection across the region, yet questions remain regarding its capacity to address a growing range of conservation threats. We investigate this by analysing over 90,000 scientific and policy documents (1961-2023) to examine how conservation threats are discussed across science and ATS policy deliberations. We find that threats originating more locally show clearer evidence of progression through the ATS's decision-making system. Threats originating within the Antarctic Treaty Area show repeated progression towards governance action, whereas external threats, including climate change, remain under prolonged deliberation or receive limited engagement altogether. These patterns suggest that the ATS has demonstrated capacity to translate sustained engagement into governance action for threats within its remit, while comparable action remains less evident for threats originating beyond it. This distinction is increasingly consequential because some of Antarctica's greatest threats originate outside the region. Strengthening coordination between the ATS and broader global governance frameworks may therefore be critical to addressing them.

Read article →

Narrowing urban heat disparities alongside faster greening in low-income neighborhoods across cities in the United States

2026-10-05 · DOI 10.1038/S41467-026-78468-Y

Jie Cao; Weiqi Zhou; Timon McPhearson; Jing Wang; Haoran Hou; Jing Liu

Abstract. Urban heat disproportionately burdens socioeconomically vulnerable communities, yet how these disparities change over time remains poorly understood. Here we show that heat disparities between low- and high-income neighborhoods generally narrowed across 55 major cities in the United States from 1986 to 2020, although substantial inequities persisted. This narrowing coincided with faster environmental improvements in disadvantaged neighborhoods, particularly greater increases in greenness. Disparity trajectories varied across climate zones, with temperate and cold cities showing narrowing heat gaps, whereas arid cities more often showed persistent or widening gaps. At the city level, environmental disparities followed diverse pathways depending on changes in both overall environmental conditions and the distribution of change between income groups. Changes in greenness disparities were more strongly associated with changes in heat disparities than were changes in cooling efficiency. These findings highlight the dynamic nature of urban environmental inequality and the importance of equitable greening in urban climate adaptation. This study finds that heat disparities between high- and low-income neighborhoods narrowed across 55 U.S. cities from 1986 to 2020, alongside faster greening in disadvantaged neighborhoods, although substantial inequalities persisted.

Read article →

Nature Human Behaviour

Algorithm-assisted personalized risk communication to encourage flu vaccination in the USA: three randomized field trials

2026-10-05 · DOI 10.1038/S41562-026-02603-4

Gail M. Rosenbaum; Amir Goren; Maheen Shermohammed; Donna M. Wolk; Ann Marie Tice; Joseph J. Doyle; Michelle N. Meyer; Christopher F. Chabris

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

Read article →

Nature Machine Intelligence

Emotional optimization by newsroom AI needs behavioural evaluation

2026-10-07 · DOI 10.1038/S42256-026-01315-8

Bence Bago; Jean-Francois Bonnefon

Abstract. Abstract unavailable.

Read article →

Political Communication

The Politics of the "Non-Political": A Conceptual Review

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1080/10584609.2026.2745844

Yufan Guo; Yibin Fan

The Chinese University of Hong Kong; University of Washington

Abstract. Recent literature has documented a growing entanglement between political processes and many nonpolitical entities. This calls into question the traditional presupposition of politics as a self-contained sphere, highlighting the need to clarify how the conceptual relationship between the political and the nonpolitical has been established. In line with a relational understanding of politics, we provide a boundary analysis by looking at the "non-political" labeling in 140 empirical studies published in political science and communication journals. Two major conceptual treatments are identified: categorical, treating the "non-political" as an inherent, exclusive feature; and contextual, viewing it as a temporary, transformative state. Intellectual traditions, theoretical orientations, methodological standards, and rhetorical norms in academic knowledge production may explain why this boundary has been constructed in such different ways. We call for a more active reconciliation between these treatments, and argue that the nonpolitical, as well as (de)politicization, should be recognized as a meaningful analytical lens. It signifies a relational stance against the explicit, institutionalized politics in political communication studies, offering an indirect yet heuristically productive response to the question of what the political is.

Read article →

Does the TikTok Feed Lean Right? Exposure to Political Content Among Non-Partisan Users in Germany

2026-10-05 · DOI 10.1080/10584609.2026.2733320

Jasper Tjaden; Johannes Wolfgram; Aaron Philipp; Sarah Weissmann; Licia Bobzien; Ulrich Kohler; Roland Verwiebe

University of Potsdam

Abstract. We evaluated disparities in exposure to partisan content among new, nonpartisan TikTok users. We performed a sock puppet audit using 118 automated users in Germany ahead of three regional elections in 2024 and the federal election in 2025 (N = 266.161 videos). The design allowed us to account for past individual user behavior, user networks, location, and time. Overall, general political content constitutes 5%-7% of nonpolitical user feeds in our sample. When nonpartisan users encounter unsolicited political content, it is more likely to feature videos mentioning and supporting the far-right populist Alternative fur Deutschland (AfD) party relative to all other parties. Further descriptive analysis shows that content by the AfD is associated with a higher volume of accounts and a higher number of viral videos.

Read article →

Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences

The more you automate, the less you see: Hidden pitfalls of autonomous AI scientists

2026-10-05 · DOI 10.1073/PNAS.2610214123

Ziming Luo; Atoosa Kasirzadeh; Nihar B. Shah

Computer Science Department, School of Computer Science, Carnegie Mellon University; Department of Philosophy, Dietrich College of Humanities and Social Sciences, Carnegie Mellon University; Machine Learning Department, School of Computer Science, Carnegie Mellon University

Abstract. The rapid rise of autonomous AI scientists marks a paradigm shift in scientific discovery by automating the research lifecycle. Yet their rushed development has outpaced critical oversight, leaving key workflow decisions dangerously unscrutinized. We present a much-needed systematic analysis of open-source AI scientist systems, investigating four primary pitfalls: inappropriate benchmark selection, data leakage, metric misuse, and post hoc selection bias. Through controlled experiments that isolate each pitfall, we find systematic vulnerabilities across two representative open-source systems. Crucially, we find that these flaws are largely invisible at the level of the final manuscript, suggesting that current manuscript-centric peer review paradigms are fundamentally insufficient for ensuring the integrity of automated research. We further propose mitigation strategies and demonstrate that access to full workflow artifacts (log traces and code) enables more effective auditing. Our findings suggest that journals, conferences, and researchers should move beyond manuscript-only evaluation toward process auditing the end-to-end workflow artifacts of AI scientist systems.

Read article →

Science

Phones impede learning: Evidence from a massive phone-free classroom experiment

2026-10-08 · DOI 10.1126/SCIENCE.AEF7249

Alp Sungu; Pradeep Kumar Choudhury; Andreas Bjerre-Nielsen

Copenhagen Center for Social Data Science (SODAS) and Department of Economics, University of Copenhagen, Copenhagen, Denmark.; Operations, Information and Decisions Department, Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, Philadelphia, PA, USA.; Zakir Husain Centre for Educational Studies, School of Social Sciences, Jawaharlal Nehru University, New Delhi, India.

Abstract. Lower-performing students benefited the most, but even higher-performing students expressed support for the policy

Read article →

Science Advances

Costly missed connections: Visitation and misconduct in California prisons

2026-10-09 · DOI 10.1126/SCIADV.AED8424

Yilin Zhuo; Kristin Turney; Naomi F. Sugie; M. Keith Chen; Emily Owens

Anderson School of Management, University of California, Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA 90095, USA.; Balbec Capital LP, New York, NY 10016, USA.; Department of Criminology, Law and Society, University of California, Irvine, Irvine, CA 92697, USA.; Department of Economics, University of California, Irvine, Irvine, CA 92697, USA.; Department of Sociology, University of California, Irvine, Irvine, CA 92697, USA.; Department of Sociology, University of California, Los Angeles, Los Angeles, CA 90095, USA.

Abstract. Social isolation is a major public health crisis with particularly deleterious consequences for vulnerable populations including incarcerated people. Theoretically, visitation from family should reduce social isolation and improve outcomes among incarcerated people, but existing quasi-experimental research provides limited support for the relationship between visitation and in-custody outcomes. We revisit the effect of visitation on in-custody misconduct-an important but administratively defined measure of institutional safety-by exploiting the fact that fluctuations in gasoline prices create unanticipated shifts in visitation uncorrelated with other factors associated with misconduct. We combine this quasi-experimental variation with smartphone mobility data identifying prison visits from cell phone pings and administrative data on misconduct in California prisons. We find that increases in visits induced by changes in transportation costs are negatively related to misconduct (particularly use-of-force events and personal battery), with effects concentrated immediately after visitation. Although the policy implications are subtle, these findings suggest that some strategies that reduce visitation barriers could be cost-effective ways to reduce prison violence. More broadly, they suggest that social connections have causal repercussions for violence and safety in extreme institutional environments.

Read article →

Mesoscale structures in signed networks

2026-10-09 · DOI 10.1126/SCIADV.AEE5886

Wei Zhang; Olga Boichak; Tristram J. Alexander; Tiago P. Peixoto; Eduardo G. Altmann

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Abstract. Mesoscale structures in signed networks have been studied under the limiting assumption of the validity of social balance theory, which predicts positive connections within groups and negative connections between groups. Here, we propose and apply a methodology that overcomes this limitation and is able to find and characterize also the different possible unbalanced structures in signed networks. Applying our methodology to 24 empirical networks, from social-political, financial, and biological domains, we find that unbalanced mesoscale structures are prevalent in real-world networks, including cases with substantial balance at the microscale of triangles. In particular, we find that assortativity often prevails regardless of the interaction sign and that core-periphery structures are typical in online social networks. Our findings highlight the complexity of mesoscale relational structures, the importance of using computational methods that are a priori agnostic to specific patterns, and the importance of independently evaluating micro- and mesoscale predictions of social balance theory.

Read article →

Previous Week Catch-Up

Science Advances

Speech clocks decode dementia phenotypes, social exposome, and biological aging

2026-10-02 · DOI 10.1126/SCIADV.AEF9864

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Abstract. Biological aging clocks offer estimations of aging and dementia, yet scalability is limited. We introduce a large-scale, cross-national speech clock derived from 2928 individuals across five Latin American countries, spanning healthy controls (HCs), mild cognitive impairment (MCI), Alzheimer's disease (AD), and non-language/language-dominant frontotemporal dementia (nldFTD/ldFTD). Multimodal acoustic and linguistic features were trained with supervised models to estimate chronological age, generating speech age gaps (SAGs) as cross-sectional markers of deviations from chronological age, with positive values interpreted as relatively older-appearing speech profiles. SAGs differentiated diagnostic groups (HCs

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